MathsJam Shout

October 2025

MathsWorld London

To celebrate the opening of MathsWorld London we have collected some of our favourite codebreaking puzzles...

Solve Secret Codes

Can you work out the secret code from the clues below?

1:	6	4	7	5	🐮
2:	5	1	3	0	🐮🐮
3:	7	3	8	0	🐮🐮
4:	0	6	3	2	🐮🐮
5:	8	5	3	2	🐮🐮
6:	1	7	3	2	🐮🐮

A white cow icon represents a correct digit in the incorrect place, and a brown cow represents a correct digit in the correct place.

Following Wordle-style rules, we have concealed a 4-digit code.

6	4	2	7
6	0	8	9
9	5	0	2
1	4	9	0

A black square represents a digit in the right place, and a blue one represents the right digit but in the wrong place. What is the correct code?

Make Code Wheels

Use the link to print your own Caesar and Enigma wheels to encode and decode these famous names (split pins may be helpful).

KXRGKJOYNIBSILGYALKT

EDUZUHMEMDMYMZGVMZ

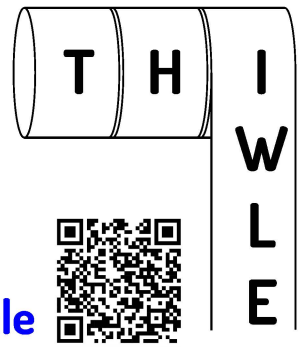
KUNVRUTFNJPPYRUYPUXLYTMU

PAPCBPIWXHDCCIJGXCV

Printable PDF: mathsj.am/wheels

Code Scytale (skit-a-lee)

A scytale is a type of transposition cipher that uses the diameter of a pole as the "key". Can decipher the messages using an ordinary pencil?



Could you make your own using a pint glass and strip of paper?

Printable PDF: mathsj.am/scytale

Make Your Own Cipher

Design your own secret method of encrypting and decrypting text. Can anyone from your MathsJam crack the code? Why not test other Jams by posting your coded messages on Mathstodon?

MathsJam Shout is a monthly sheet of ideas for activities to do at a MathsJam night. It's created using suggestions from a different MathsJam each month, and if you'd like to submit suggestions for a month in the future, email **katie@mathsjam.com** for details.

MathsJam is a monthly opportunity for like-minded self-confessed maths enthusiasts to get together in a pub and share stuff they like. Puzzles, games, problems, or just anything they think is cool or interesting. Monthly MathsJam nights happen in over 70 locations around the world, on the second-to-last Tuesday of each month. To find your nearest MathsJam, visit the website at **www.mathsjam.com**.